

Exploratory Scenario Planning (XSP)

A Methodology for navigating uncertainties in Ukrainian Pilot cities



What is Exploratory Scenario Planning?

Exploratory Scenario Planning (XSP) explores multiple plausible futures instead of predicting a single one, designed for contexts of high uncertainty.



Plausible Futures

A range of scenarios, not one forecast



Uncertainty-First

Starts from what we do not know



Participatory

Co-created with citizens & stakeholders



Action-Oriented

Outputs feed directly into decisions



Iterative

Revisable as conditions evolve

These uncertainties demand a methodology that starts from what is unknown — not one that assumes stability.

Why Exploratory Scenario Planning?

Planning context: compounding uncertainties



Armed Conflict & War

Infrastructure disrupted, governance capacity weakened, planning horizon deeply uncertain.



Dual Transition Pressure

Post-war recovery and EU climate integration create competing demands on municipalities.



Climate Uncertainty

Climate impacts compound war-related damage, requiring adaptive, resilient responses.



Citizen Engagement Gap

Traditional participation breaks down in fragile contexts — yet buy-in is essential.

Why Exploratory Scenario Planning?



Embraces Uncertainty

Starts from what is not known , ideal for war-disrupted contexts.



Builds Local Legitimacy

Co-created ownership critical where trust is fragile.



Decision-Relevant Outputs

Robustness analysis guides real investment choices.



Dual-Transition Compatible

Tests climate and recovery pathways simultaneously.



Transferable Design

Same 3-step method across all 6 cities , consistent yet localized.



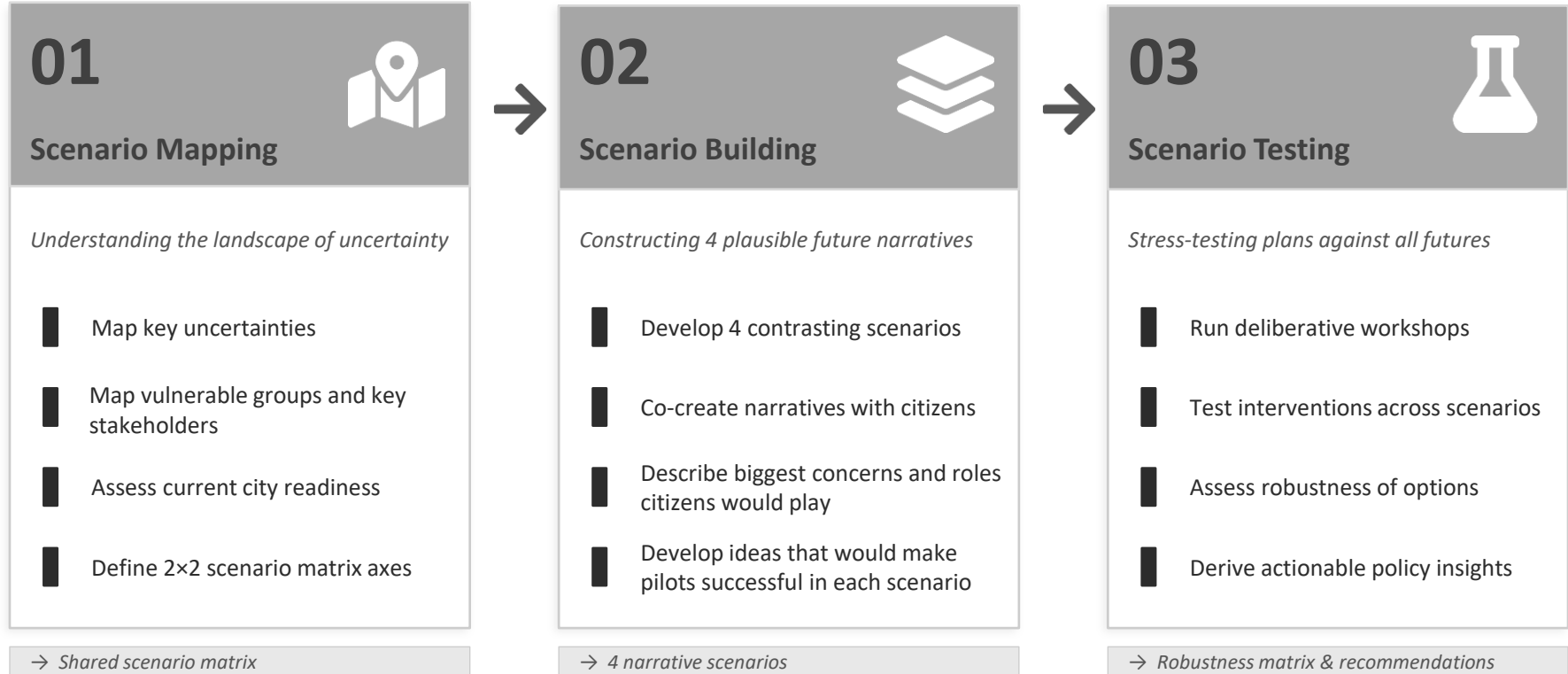
EU-Aligned Process

Recognized best practice in EU climate governance frameworks.

These uncertainties demand a methodology that starts from what is unknown — not one that assumes stability.

The 3-step XSP framework

A structured, participatory approach applied consistently across all six pilot cities, with localised content



Stakeholder engagement is embedded throughout all three steps not just as an add-on, but a core design feature.

Key Takeaways

Uncertainty is the starting point

XSP does not predict, it prepares cities for multiple plausible futures, like for Ukraine's volatile context.

Citizens are co-authors

Scenarios built with communities have greater legitimacy and are more likely to catalyse real change in local governance.

3 integrated steps

Mapping → Building → Testing creates a coherent process with distinct outputs and continuous feedback loops.

Feeds pilot implementation

Scenario outputs directly inform which interventions to pursue and is grounded in robustness, not just aspiration.



TECHNISCHE
UNIVERSITÄT
DRESDEN



WISSENS
ARCHITEKTUR



Funded by
the European Union



Thank you

